

## Urban Reconstruction Technical Working Group (UR-TWG)

### Session 6

31<sup>st</sup> Dec 2019, 3:15-4:45 PM, HRRP Office, Jwagal

### **Meeting Agenda**

- Sharing initial findings from qualitative surveys
- Identifying methodology for qualitative survey data analysis
- Identifying key parameters for quantitative survey

#### **1. Sharing initial findings from qualitative surveys**

##### **HRRP:**

- High retrofitting beneficiaries (FGDs and KII completed): Very low awareness on retrofitting, weak financial conditions and land issues are the major barriers for urban recovery. Most of the beneficiaries are still awaiting the beneficiary status change from retrofit to reconstruction. Frequent change of NRA policies too has discouraged beneficiaries to reconstruct/retrofit. Resource and capacity development on retrofitting was suggested as a solution to the barriers.
- No presence of PO (FGDs and KII completed): Limited access to socio-technical assistance is the major barrier in urban recovery. Beneficiaries need to solely depend on NRA technical persons for every information related to reconstruction. Considering the high case-loads of NRA technical persons, beneficiaries cannot be assured timely assistance. Small plot of land too is an issue for many beneficiaries, though NRA has feasibility to construct according to the plinth coverage of pre-existing house, building permits cannot be acquired for land area less than 2 anna- 2 paisa, as no land certificate is issued for plots smaller than the standard area.

##### **Lumanti:**

- One FGD and KII each at Siddhipur Municipality and Mahalaxmi Municipality has been completed. Will be conducting the survey in Thecho possibly in the first week of January.
- At Siddhipur, the participants were mostly female and they, but mostly single women, had no idea on beneficiary status and methods of receiving tranche. Almost all of the participants had constructed their houses, but they were not aware on the process for receiving grants. NRA technical persons usually visit only twice a week. Another barrier to reconstruction is land issues, mostly smaller land plots. Though NPRs. 50,000 is supported for traditional buildings by the municipality, owing the high cost of construction, beneficiaries at the traditional settlement are not encouraged for constructions.
- At Mahalaxmi, the beneficiaries are still not aware about the building permit system. The municipality is working to provide some feasibility in the bye-laws to encourage constructions. Some beneficiaries have taken loans from multiple sources. Selling land

or migrating abroad for work are the solutions to pay back the loan. The ward officials complained the tedious tranche process as a barrier to urban recovery.

NSET:

- Conducted FGD and KII but still more details required, will complete in a week time period.
- Multiple ownership though has solved many pending reconstructions, is one of the major challenges well. Owing to the high cost of construction and smaller land plots, there are beneficiaries who want to go for divisions of total number of rooms as previously rather than going for horizontal sub divisions of flats as per multiple ownership guideline.
- Multiple ownership also has affected the retrofit beneficiaries. Multiple beneficiaries residing in a single house can get only one full retrofit tranche but if the beneficiaries apply for conversion to reconstruction beneficiary, can get three reconstruction tranches. If similar provisions like reconstruction is made even for the retrofit beneficiaries, they will retrofit.
- Bhimeshwor Municipality, whereas wants to demolish the traditional houses instead of conservation as the settlement violates the RoW standards. The conservation and façade preservation work too are not fully compliant to the conservation standards as the drawing consultants are not fully aware of the standards and there are no masons fully skilled in traditional constructions.

CRS:

- FGDs and KIIs completed in Gorkha Municipality and Manthali Municipality.
- High cost of construction, land issues, RoW, etc. have been shared as the major barriers of recovery.

**2. Identifying methodology for qualitative survey data analysis**

- Key word identification can be a method for data analysis for the qualitative survey but will decide on further meetings.

**3. Identifying key parameters for quantitative survey**

- Resource constraint needs to be considered for sample size determination for the quantitative survey. Further discussions and coordination will be required for the possibilities of sharing resources, involving university students and NRA social mobilizers.
- Working session to identify key parameters:

| LAND                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | FINANCE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | SOCIO-TECHNICAL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | POLICY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Size</li> <li>- Land ownership documents and types</li> <li>- Process</li> <li>- Awareness on land transfer</li> <li>- Cost/Area for urban and peri-urban</li> <li>- No. of landless beneficiaries</li> <li>- Land use types</li> <li>- No. of vulnerable beneficiaries</li> <li>- Risk/Hazardous land</li> <li>- Heritage/Traditional settlements</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Access to finance               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Savings</li> <li>Loan</li> <li>Both</li> </ul> </li> <li>- Selling assets</li> <li>- Source of loan, Interest, Collateral type, Payment period, documentation required</li> <li>- Information on loan, govt. policies on loan</li> <li>- Tranche: Information, Process, Status</li> <li>- Access of finance for livelihood improvement: Loans, access to trainings for livelihood enhancement</li> <li>- Part of social security network: member of cooperatives, kind of support received, loan, others</li> <li>- Bank/Cooperatives/Microfinance Institutes: Process</li> <li>- Challenges in each of the above, suggestions for improvement</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- No. of trained masons available</li> <li>- No. of engineers, social mobilizers, local leaders trained</li> <li>- Support for house design</li> <li>- Support during construction</li> <li>- IEC materials on safer construction</li> <li>- Access to model construction</li> <li>- Distance to local information center (Ward, Municipality, District offices)</li> <li>- Time period of technical support, inspection</li> <li>- Involvement in orientation sessions</li> <li>- Most suitable and used mode of communication and information seeking</li> <li>- Design approvals at municipality</li> <li>- Difficulty level for building permits</li> <li>- No. of masons trained in traditional construction</li> <li>- Availability of design catalogue</li> <li>- Support for demolition</li> <li>- Capacity of NRA and POs engineers to provide support on traditional construction, adjoining houses, retrofitting, building permit process, building design</li> <li>- Availability of consultants, designers</li> <li>- Technical capacity for retrofitting of adjoining and long houses</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Level of awareness, NRA and Municipal related</li> <li>- Timely development and dissemination of policies</li> <li>- New policies required</li> <li>- Grievance redressal mechanism</li> <li>- Effectiveness of orientations</li> <li>- Implementation (Process documentation, no. of cases solved, level of awareness)</li> <li>- Acceptance of building code, bylaws and building permit</li> <li>- Disputes between local and national policies</li> <li>- Institutionalization at local level</li> </ul> |

**Next Meeting:** Third week of January

**Participants List**

**Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform(HRRP)**  
**Urban-TWG Meeting**

Date: 31 December, 2019

**Venue:** HRRP Office, Jwagal, Lalitpur

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